Annexation (“Manifest Destiny”)

John L. O'Sullivan · July 1845

Source: John L. O'Sullivan, “Annexation” (1845). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Defending the annexation of Texas, O'Sullivan coined the era's rallying cry: it was America's “manifest destiny to overspread the continent,” a Providence-given right that justified westward expansion to the Pacific.

It surely is to be found . . . in the manner in which other nations have undertaken to intrude themselves . . . for the avowed object of thwarting our policy and hampering our power, limiting our greatness and checking the fulfillment of our manifest destiny to overspread the continent allotted by Providence for the free development of our yearly multiplying millions.

[. . .]

The Anglo-Saxon foot is already on its borders. Already the advance guard of the irresistible army of Anglo-Saxon emigration has begun to pour down upon it, armed with the plow and the rifle, and marking its trail with schools and colleges, courts and representative halls, mills and meeting-houses. A population will soon be in actual occupation of California, over which it will be idle for Mexico to dream of dominion.